Puddin' and Soul Food: A Duel with Death at Lunchtime

By Mike McGee

INTRODUCTION

This is a love poem, but not to any specific person. Oh, no . . . this is a love poem to specific substance. One that we're all familiar with. Ladies and Gentleman, that substance is Pudding. I'm concerned for your safety. For those of you who are already experiencing pangs of hunger, I urge you to leave the room. For those of you who wish to stay, please . . . . Picture a buffet unlike any other where beautiful people of your dreams have gathered to feed you the silky delicacy known as Puddin' by Mike McGee

Puddin'

Imagine that they

are also enveloped by ecstasy,

so into the feast they keep referring to the substance

as

Puddin'.

So drawn to it

they forget the letter "G"

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I would like to take moment to speak directly to that in which this poem was written.

Hello, Pudding.

Oh how I miss you, baby.

How I long to be near your bowl

with a very tiny spoon,

so that I can take my time

and enjoy you.

To caress your shapeless existence.

To watch you do that gelatinous jiggle you do so well just before I consume you with all the passion I learned from Bill Cosby himself.

Goddamn you, Pudding.

How dare you disguise yourself.

Who will you be tonight, my sweet?

Hmm?

Maybe a bowl of tapioca,

a taste of butterscotch,

or will you be more complex,

donning a vanilla chocolate ripple,

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hiding away in my freezer,
hugging a stick
and only succumbing to the name pudding pop.

Ohhhhh, Pudding.
Temptation is for the weak,
so please call me Weakly Weakerson when I am near you.
Me and my band the Week Tones
will play you songs of desire and merriment
and if that doesn't work for you, my dear, sweet Pudding.
I can always put on my Marlo Brando costume.
The one that seems to turn you on the most.
The one that gets you all thick and creamy.
Ohhhh, Pudding.
The Horror, The Horror.

I could just drink you from a straw out in my front yard,
naked
in an inflatable kiddie pool
full of you.

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The envy and confusion of all those walking by would
make it well worth the effort.

We now interrupt this poem to bring you viable content
in an attempt to make this poem more accessible to a
broader audience.

Peace in the Middle East
Allah at a play
Word for a Nerd
My Father Never Loved Me
I Wanna Make a Difference
I suck
You Suck
Bush Sucks

Now back to the poem already in progress . . .

I could cover myself with you and go as you to a
masquerade ball.
People will want to lick you off of me,

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but I'll say

Nooooooooo

I will lick me.

For a I have a tongue

and a book on Yoga.

Nooks and crannies.

However, our love is limited,

for I've discovered that my colon cannot possibly

tolerate our passion much longer. You are composed

with the blood of milk

and I

shall rather die than make you with water.

So let us call for one last night of nasty.

Let me sing your praises.

For now I shall summon the spirit of Bill Cosby and say

to you this:

Zippa Zang

Chaz a Piece of damn

saz a faz,

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Wednesday's hump day,

Kodak Moment,

Ha!

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Mike McGee
Book: In Search of Midnight: The Mike McGee Handbook of Awesome
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TRANSITION

Let's face it, food can inspire intense emotions. Some people eat when they are happy, or sad, or anxious. In fact, we have such an emotional connection to food that obesity is an overwhelming concern for a growing (ha ha) number of Americans today. And everyone has a favorite food. You know, the one that you hide from the rest of your family so that you don't have to share. Or the one that, hands-down, you know you could win with if challenged to an eating contest. 87 cups of puddin' in less than 3 mintues! Whoo Whoo. So how many do you think you could eat if the prize wasn't a new car or a life-time supply of Rice-a-Roni? What if the prize was your ETERNAL SOUL?

Soul Food: A Duel with Death at Lunchtime by Mike McGee.

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Soul Food: A Duel with Death at Lunchtime

So last week the Angel of Death comes knocking at my door
Totally interrupting Perfect Strangers
And I'm like, "Dude, you are so early! There is so much more I wanted to do with my life!"

"You've had plenty of time for that!"
"You know, you sound a bit like Sean Connery."
"No, he sounds a bit like me."
"Whatever, dude. There's gotta be some sort of loop-hole. What if we competed for my soul? Like some sort of contest."
"I love a good challenge. If we can both agree on one, then the winner may keep your soul."

At this point I remembered I had a pot a ramen noodles waiting for me on the stove. The Angel of Death was lured into my kitchen by the sweet aromatic joy of powdered shrimp flavoring. I could see that Death was

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hungry, so I made a second pack of Ramen. We sat and ate in silence, but my hunger just wouldn't subside. So while I raided the fridge, I noticed Death scoping my Rice Krispy Treats.

"Still hungry, dude?"
"We'll take one for the road." he said.
And we both put a Rice Krispy treat in our pockets.
"Actually, I could probably eat half of all your food."
"So could I, dude, so could I."

And it hit us both at the same time. We pulled out every bit of food in my house and divided it all into equal halves. We had one rule: First person to finish eating their half of food keeps my soul.

We sat down on the kitchen floor surrounded by an odd buffet. The world's greatest food challenge began. But this was no ordinary match.

I took an early lead as Death fumbled opening a can of

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refried beans. I plowed through a dozen eggs and half a gallon of milk. I strategically swallowed spoonful after spoonful of leftover lasagna, without chewing. Death caught up to me with a tub of butter and half a soggy pumpkin pie. I hustled my way through cans of corn, green beans, kidney beans, chili, chicken soup, fruit cocktail, and a few cans of peas, but I was stopped dead in my tracks by a mystery can. It's label missing and nowhere to be found. Damn, dog food! No time to think, I had to eat it.

Death was now ahead of me by two-cans of beer, a frozen steak and what we think may have been tamales. I burped to make room and continued on in the feast for my soul. I ate broccoli, cauliflower, cucumbers, oranges, bananas, a container of baking powder, two cups of salt & pepper, a jug of Pepto-Bismol and a can of whipped cream. We reached our last item of food. One. Raw. Potato. Each. We slowly gnawed our way through the raw potatoes, swallowing our last bites at the exact same time. It appeared as though we had a draw. Then Death

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looked to me with a sly grin and handed me a Tupperware bowl with my half of uneaten Jello. I grabbed a straw and sucked it down, saying:

"There's always room for Jello!"

But Death just smiled and said, "I believe I finished my half before you. Your soul is mine."

But I just outsmiled him and said, "What's that in your pocket?"

His face sunk as he reached into his pocket and pulled out the last Rice Krispy Treat.
He looked to me with fear as I handed him my wrapper, and swallowed a mouthful of crispy, marshmallow goodness. "I believe I win.."
With that, the Angel of Death bowed and vanished.

I sat down to an episode of Full House and ordered a

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pizza...

cuz there's never anything to eat at my house.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Mike McGee
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AWARD HISTORY

2009 National Qualifier
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